



Rotman

RITCxCMU 2026

Welcome to the Getting Started Resources page for RITCxCMU 2026

Thursday, September 10, 2026



Share



RITCxCMU 2026

September 19, 2026

Undergraduate and Graduate students from both campuses of Carnegie Mellon University are invited to participate in the Rotman International Trading Competition (RITC)xCMU 2026, supported by the Finance Research and Trading Lab at the Rotman School of Management (Rotman FRT-Lab), hosted by Carnegie Mellon University in Pittsburgh.

RITCxCMU 2026 brings together teams of students to compete in a unique 1-day simulated market challenge where they test their skills in real-time from the safety of a structured learning environment.

The challenge is a perfect place to acquire and enhance your skills using the FRT-Lab's experiential tools in preparation for **Rotman International Trading Competition 2027**.

Awards	
Training and Practice Sessions (Zoom)	
Awards Prior to the competition, please join us for:	
Sponsors	
Awards Participation Awards Qualification Awards ■ the required virtual practice session :	
September 18th, 2026 at 7:00 pm - 9:00 pm Each team must consist of two current students. Awards 9:00 - 9:30 Please download the Rotman Interactive	
Trading Case were sent to you via email. machine. Sponsor Presentations	
Mac users can access RIT online or install the RIT Mac	
11:45 - 12:30 Scroll to the "Software Setup" section for details. Case Summary	
Lunch VOLATILITY TRADING CASE	
12:30 - 1:15	

VOLATILITY TRADING CASE

The Volatility Trading Case gives participants the opportunity to generate profits by implementing options strategies to trade volatility. The underlying asset of the options

The Algorithmic ETF Arbitrage Case trades in the EFT called RIM that tracks a major stock index. Participants will be able to trade shares of the ETF and call/put options at different strike prices. Information including the ETF price, options prices, and news on ETFs will be provided. Individual participants are encouraged to use the provided Trading Case #2

Participants will be able to trade shares of the ETF and call/put options at different strike prices. Information including the ETF price, options prices, and news on ETFs will be provided. Individual participants are encouraged to use the provided Trading Case #2

Please see the detailed case information from [this link](#).

Please visit the **RIT Market Simulator Package website** to follow instructions to download and install the RIT User Application.

The decision support files are available in **Excel**, and in Python through **REST API** (for user) and **DMA API** (for browser and Mac App user).

These algorithms must be capable of submitting orders, responding to market opportunities, and adapting to fast-changing market conditions. Success will require identifying and capitalizing on price differentials between market and order offer prices. There are two building resilient adaptive code that can handle the high-frequency nature of the environment.

■ **Use it in your browser.** Go to <https://client.rotmanrit.com:14980/> and log in with Award Ceremony. Please see the detailed case information from [this link](#).

■ **Or install the Mac app.** Download it here: The decision support files are available in Python through **REST API** (for Windows RIT user) and **DMA API** (for browser and Mac App user).

RIT Client for Silicon (M1, M2, M3, M4) or

RIT Client for Mac - Intel

Unzip it, and drag "RIT Market Simulator" to your Applications folder. Double-click it and your browser opens at the login page. **Note that there are two versions: Apple Silicon for M1, M2, M3 and M4 Macs, and Intel for older ones.** Check which you have under Apple menu → About This Mac. The app is signed and notarized by Apple, so it opens normally with no security warnings, and it works from home as well as on campus.

If your network blocks the browser address above, use the downloadable app instead. It connects to the RIT server directly.

This is a beta test version. Please send any encountered issues, with an explanation of what was occurring at the time, to financelab@rotman.utoronto.ca.

NOTE: We strongly recommend using the Client-based REST API instead of the RIT DMA

API during the competition. This API has proven to be more stable, reliable, and easier to implement, allowing you to focus on strategy rather than troubleshooting technical issues.

The Client-based REST API has shown better stability across various scenarios, reducing the risk of disruptions. It's simpler to set up and use, ensuring fewer complications and smoother operation during the competition. Also, It's important to start with the base algorithm provided, as it forms the foundation for all enhancements and customizations you may wish to implement.

Should you encounter issues that cannot be resolved through the provided resources, feel free to reach out to our team at financelab@rotman.utoronto.ca and we will be happy to assist you further. We highly encourage you to follow this recommendation for a seamless competition experience, and we wish you the best of luck as you finalize your preparations!

Connection Instructions

- Use your RIT credentials to connect to the server and port above (Trader ID and Password).
- Once you are connected, messages on your RIT will keep you informed throughout the session about the next steps.
- We will briefly explain the platform and run a few practice rounds of the case.
- We will run the competition rounds, save the results, aggregate them and share during the Awards Ceremony.
- The server port is only active during the competition day.

Access Credentials

When registration closes, we will send you an email including your unique RIT Trader IDs & Password for the competition.

For Example:

- Trader ID #1: ABCD-1
- Trader ID #2: ABCD-2
- Team Password: apples

RIT Credentials give your team access to:

- Practice Server
- Practice Sessions
- Competition Day

Practice Server

- The Practice Server allows you to explore RIT prior to the Competition Day.
- The Practice Server will be disabled on Competition Day.
- To log into any Practice Server port, please use the access credentials that were provided to you via email.
- The case structure on practice servers and during the competition will be the same, but market dynamics may be different depending on the participants' trading behaviour. Price paths will also be different during the competition. In addition, market parameters during the competition may be adjusted to better account for over 100 live traders.
- Trading Cases will have new, randomized sets of security paths each time they are run on the practice server.

Practice Server Details

Practice Servers will be enabled from September 11, 2026 by 12PM until the day of the competition.

Volatility Trading Case practice server details

- Server host name: flserver.rotman.utoronto.ca
- Server port:
 - 16590 (Windows RIT)
 - 16595 (Browser, Mac App)

Algorithmic EFT Arbitrage Trading Case practice server details

- Server host name: flserver.rotman.utoronto.ca
- Server port:
 - 16630 (Windows RIT)
 - 16635 (Browser, Mac App)

Scoring Methodology

The scoring and ranking methodology is designed to translate absolute performance into relative performance using a ranking system. This ranking system is designed to discourage participants from “betting the house” in one heat and generating very large absolute profits that will result in a clear win of the entire competition. Instead, participants’ absolute performance in each heat is converted into a series of ordinal ranks which are subsequently converted into a final case ranking. These case rankings are mapped to case scores and then combined under the 50/50 weight for each case.

Volatility Trading Case: for each heat, the penalty-adjusted final profits and losses (P&L) of all participating members of a team are summed to form a dollar value of the team P&L. The teams are then ranked for each heat by the dollar values of the team P&L with 1st place given to the team with the highest dollar value. In the event of a tie, the teams that have tied will be given the same rank. The teams below the tie will be given a rank based on the number of teams that have scored better than them. Therefore, if three teams tied for 2nd place, the ranking for the top five teams would be 1st, 2nd, 2nd, 2nd, and 5th.

Each team’s heat ranks are then averaged. Teams are then ranked based on their average heat rank to determine their final case rank. The team with the lowest average will be ranked first.

This case ranking is then mapped to a point score where the lowest rank (best score) is given a score of $n+1$, where n is the number of teams below you plus the teams that tied with you (i.e. the first place team out of 52 teams will get a score of 52, the last place team will get a score of 1). To continue the above example, if you are tied for 2nd place with three other teams, you will get a score of 51.

Algorithmic ETF Arbitrage Trading Case: Only one member from each team will be required to participate in the Algorithmic Market Making Case. The final P&L of the participating team member will become the team P&L, which will be then ranked for each heat with first place awarded to the team with the highest dollar value. In the event of a tie, the teams that have tied will be given the same rank. The teams below the tie will be given a rank based on the number of teams that have scored better than them. Therefore, if three teams tied for 2nd place, the ranking would be 1st, 2nd, 2nd, 2nd, and 5th.

Based on the above, each team’s heat ranks will be averaged and then the resulting averages will be ranked to determine the final case rank. The team with the lowest average will be ranked first. This case ranking is then mapped to a point score where the lowest rank is given a score of $n+1$, where n is the number of teams below you plus the teams that tied with you.

Final Score: The final case scores are then multiplied by their case-weights (50% each) to form a final weighted score. This final weighted score is used to rank teams, where the highest score is the best score. In the case of two or more teams having the same final weighted score, those teams will be ranked based on the variance of their final case scores. The team with the lowest variance will be ranked ahead of the others.

Two (or more) teams that have the same score and the same variance will tie. In the event of a tie, the teams that have tied will be given the same rank. The teams below the tie will be given a rank based on the number of teams that have scored better than them. Therefore, if three teams tied for 2nd place, the ranking would be 1st, 2nd, 2nd, 2nd, and 5th.

Dress Code

RITC_x is a professional business competition, so participants are expected to dress in business casual or business formal attire.

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